SOFTWARE SWARGAM

NOT FOR EMPLOYEES

GENRE Romantic Comedy | Workplace Comedy | Commercial Entertainer **LANGUAGE** Telugu
SETTING Hyderabad

LOGLINE

A small-town engineering graduate lands his dream job at a Hyderabad software company and believes he has reached heaven — until a jealous team lead turns the office into a nightmare, and the fresher who once worshipped his boss decides to rewrite the rules himself.

SYNOPSIS

For Thota Narayana — Tony to everyone who knows him — the year after his B.Tech in Kerala has felt endless. Back in his village, every relative has a theory about why he is still unemployed. So when an offer letter finally arrives from Seven Stars Information and Technology in Hyderabad, Tony is certain he has been admitted to heaven. He moves into a cramped paying-guest room with Devi, a roommate who quickly becomes his closest friend, and on his very first morning he is waiting at the office gate before even the watchman arrives.

Tony embraces corporate life with the devotion of a pilgrim. He learns his teammates by their job titles — Debugger Dinesh, Testing Trisha, Developer Deekshit, Production Pawan, Cloud Kowshick and the rest — and saves his team lead's number not as **"Team Lead"** but as **"The Lord."** He even prints Mohith's photograph and hangs it on the wall of his room, to Devi's endless amusement.

The one person Tony cannot charm is Niharika, the disciplined, quietly brilliant engineer assigned as his mentor. Every day he asks whether she has eaten; every day she asks whether he has finished his work. Her focus only deepens his fascination. Mohith, meanwhile, has long admired Niharika himself, and he does not enjoy watching the new fresher hover around her desk.

Tony's first real test arrives by accident. A faulty commit of his slips into production and the entire application collapses. Niharika restores the stable version, but Mohith humiliates her in front of the team rather than own the failure. Stung by guilt, Tony stays back until 1:30 a.m., rewrites the code properly and pushes a clean fix. When he apologises, Niharika sees for the first time that behind the jokes is someone who takes responsibility — and who is genuinely good at his job.

At the office Dasara celebration, Niharika arrives in a saree and the whole floor falls silent. Tony dances, sings and makes no secret of whom he is singing to. Mohith ends her evening by burying her in fresh work, keeping her at her desk long after everyone else has gone. On his way home with a cake for a friend's birthday, Tony notices the office lights still burning and her scooter outside. He goes back up — and as the clock strikes midnight, an Outlook notification reveals that it is Niharika's birthday. With a quickly changed name on the cake, he gives her a celebration she never expected, in an office she had expected to sit in alone. Something between them changes that night.

Deekshit, the team's self-appointed spy, notices — and reports everything to Mohith. What follows is a slow, deliberate squeeze. Tony is handed impossible deadlines and midnight assignments, and the boy who once arrived before the watchman now comes home at two and three in the morning. Over late-night drinks in the PG, he and Devi dissect the industry's glossy promises, and the photograph of "The Lord" quietly acquires a new and unprintable caption.

The breaking point comes when Tony learns that Mohith has been speaking contemptuously about him and Niharika to another team lead. He storms into Mohith's cabin; the confrontation nearly turns physical, and Tony slams his resignation on the desk. He urges Niharika to leave with him, but she refuses. To her, Mohith is a demanding lead, not a dangerous man, and Tony's anger looks like jealousy. Their first real quarrel leaves both of them wounded.

Serving his two-month notice period, Tony stops pretending. He works at his own pace and answers back, and at a team dinner a few drinks unlock months of swallowed resentment, leaving his colleagues stunned — and a little afraid of the fresher they once teased.

Then Mohith overplays his hand. Keeping Niharika back late one night, he proposes. When she says no, he refuses to accept her answer, and his pleading turns into harassment. The watchman calls Tony, who arrives in time to stop him. In that moment Niharika finally sees Mohith for who he is, and she and Tony find their way back to each other.

The company's answer is a pink slip. Before his notice period is over, HR informs Tony that he is no longer required. In a defiant, crowd-pleasing confrontation in front of the entire floor, Tony takes on Mohith and the management, tells them exactly what their "dream workplace" costs the people inside it, and makes it clear that he will not pay for a salary with his self-respect.

But Tony does not leave quietly. He knows exactly how much the project depends on the code he has written, and on his way out he deliberately pushes faulty code into production. It is no accident and no routine bug. It is a calculated, reckless act of revenge — a line most people would never cross — by a man who has decided that the rules were never written for people like him.

The next morning, the application is down and the office is empty. Moved by Tony's stand, the employees have walked out on strike against the culture that crushed him. With a failing product, a deserted floor and management's conduct now impossible to hide, the CEO has nowhere left to turn. He calls Tony back, and Tony returns not to plead for his old job but to set terms: employees must be treated with dignity and respect, the toxic culture must end, Mohith must be removed as team lead, and Niharika must take his place. The CEO accepts every condition.

Tony walks back into Seven Stars a different man. The wide-eyed fresher who once printed his team lead's photograph has become someone who knows his own worth. The software swargam he dreamed of finally exists — not because the company offered it, but because its employees forced open the door.

A story about the dream job, the people inside it, and the price of self-respect.